

LOS SANTOS NEWS NETWORK

STATE OF SAN ANDREAS PRESS CORPS • EST. 2023



OFFICIAL CORPORATE PUBLICATION

FIELD & OPERATIONAL EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

Standard Operating Procedures, Journalistic Ethics & Media Protocols



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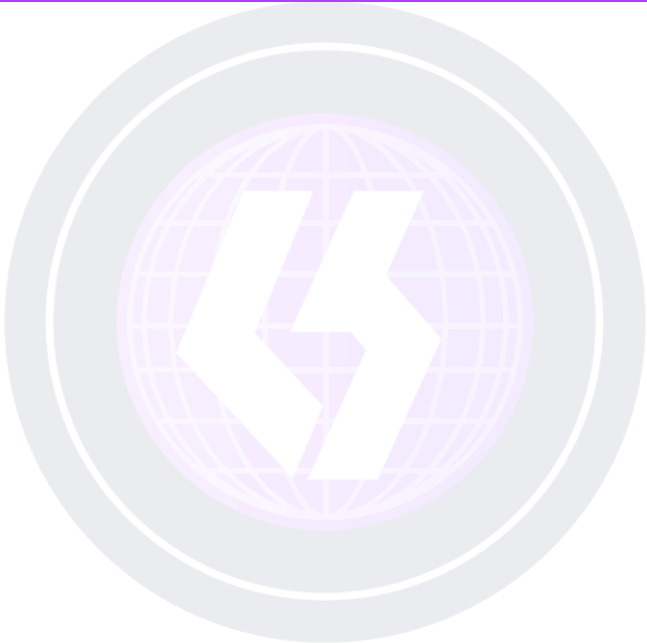
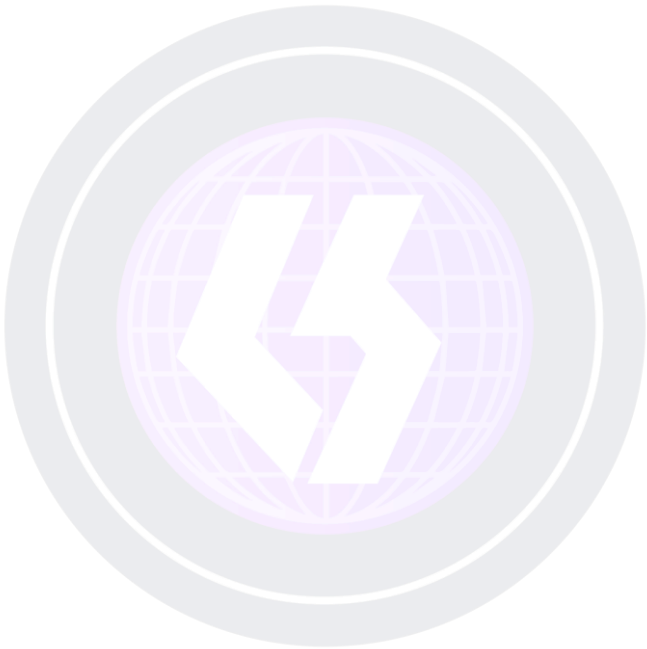


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Divisional Fast-Track Reading Guide

Corporate Operational Role	Essential Priority Chapters	Core Compliance & Operational Focus
Investigative Reporters & Photojournalists	Ch. I, II, IV, V, VIII	Shield Law, SPJ Ethics, Sourcing Tiers, Crime Scene OPSEC
TV Anchors, RJ & Broadcast Technicians	Ch. I, II, VI, VIII	On-Air Decorum, MCR Audio Link, Outside Broadcast Safety
Account Executives & Commercial Marketing	Ch. I, III, VII, IX	Commercial Ad Blacklist, Gross Treasury Remittance, Rate Cards
Executive Producers & Managing Editors	Comprehensive (Ch. I–IX)	Corporate Governance, Editorial Clearance, Progressive Sanctions



Chapter I.
General Information
& Press Legislation

1.1 Executive Welcome & Operational Philosophy

Welcome to the Los Santos News Network (LSNN).

As the premier news and broadcasting institution in the State of San Andreas, LSNN bears a public mandate to deliver reporting that is rapid, accurate, independent, and balanced. The trust of Los Santos citizens in our journalism is not built upon sensationalism, but through diligent field reporting, rigorous fact verification, and strict adherence to professional journalistic ethics.

This *Field & Operational Employee Handbook* serves as a practical, technical, and ethical manual for all personnel. Every reporter, camera operator, radio jockey, marketing representative, and managing editor is required to understand and abide by its provisions in daily field operations.

1.2 Legal Standing & Role of the Press in San Andreas

LSNN operates under the protections and regulations of the State of San Andreas press statutes:

1. **Right to Gather and Disseminate News:** Accredited LSNN journalists carrying an official Press Pass possess the legal right to observe, investigate, photograph, record, and broadcast events of public interest occurring in public spaces.
2. **Limits of Press Privilege:** A Press Pass is a professional identification credential, not a grant of legal immunity. Personnel **MUST NOT** utilize press credentials to violate criminal laws, trespass onto private property without consent, incite public disorder, or impede active law enforcement operations.
3. **Duty of Factual Verification:** All material broadcast or published to the public **MUST** undergo independent fact-checking and strictly adhere to the presumption of innocence.

1.3 San Andreas Shield Law (Confidential Source Protection)

To preserve the independence of the press and safeguard informant safety, LSNN operates under the *San Andreas Shield Law*:

1. **Privilege of Confidentiality:** Journalists **MAY** exercise the legal right to refuse disclosure of the identity of confidential informants or whistleblowers to any third party, including law enforcement agencies, absent a direct subpoena issued by a state superior court.
2. **Criteria for Anonymity:** Confidential status **MAY ONLY** be extended to sources facing legitimate, demonstrable threats of physical retaliation, severe legal reprisal, or unjust termination of livelihood as a direct consequence of providing vital public interest information.
3. **Custody of Notes:** Contact logs, unedited audio recordings, or records identifying confidential informants **MUST** be encrypted and secured under the direct oversight of the Producer of News Room or Executive Producer.

1.4 Defamation, Libel & Slander Policy

To protect the network from civil liability and defamation lawsuits that threaten corporate standing, all reporters **MUST** adhere to strict attribution standards:

1. **Definitions:**
 - a. **Libel:** Defamatory statements published in written form (news articles, web posts, on-screen text banners).
 - b. **Slander:** Defamatory statements broadcast verbally (live radio feeds, on-air interviews, voice recordings).
2. **Factual Evidence vs. Opinion:** Any report alleging criminal conduct or severe misconduct by an individual or commercial enterprise **MUST** be supported by verified official documentation (law enforcement releases, court filings, or authenticated recordings).
3. **Qualifying Language:** Reporters **MUST** utilize objective qualifying terminology such as "alleged", "suspected", "person of interest", or "according to law enforcement statements".

Personnel **MUST NOT** label an individual as a criminal or convict prior to a final verdict by a court of law.

4. **Right of Reply:** Any party subject to negative coverage or severe public accusations **MUST** be afforded a fair, documented opportunity to respond or offer rebuttal prior to publication or immediately following broadcast.

1.5 Scope of Authority & Binding Compliance

1. The rules and procedures herein are legally binding upon all active LSNN personnel, from probationary Trainees and Interns to the Chief Executive Officer.

2. Ignorance of this handbook is never accepted as a defense for operational negligence or ethical breaches.

3. Interpretation of Normative Mandates (RFC 2119 Standard):

To eliminate ambiguity in operational compliance and internal disciplinary adjudication, the following normative keywords are utilized throughout this handbook:

- a. **MUST / SHALL / REQUIRED:** Denotes an absolute institutional obligation. Non-compliance constitutes operational negligence and **SHALL** trigger disciplinary review under the Progressive Disciplinary System.
- b. **MUST NOT / SHALL NOT:** Denotes an absolute institutional prohibition.
- c. **SHOULD / RECOMMENDED:** Denotes professional journalistic standards and procedural best practices. Departure requires demonstrable editorial justification to the News Room Desk.
- d. **SHOULD NOT / NOT RECOMMENDED:** Denotes unacceptable practices that degrade journalistic credibility and **SHOULD NOT** occur under normal operational conditions.
- e. **MAY / OPTIONAL:** Denotes operational discretion granted to accredited personnel based on dynamic real-time field assessments.

Chapter II.
The Code of Ethics
(SPJ Benchmark)

LSNN adopts the four foundational pillars of the *Society of Professional Journalists (SPJ) Code of Ethics*:

2.1 Seek Truth and Report It

1. **The Two-Source Rule:** Sensitive allegations, breaking disaster reports, or criminal charges **MUST** be corroborated by at least two independent, credible sources prior to transmission.
2. **Anti-Fabrication:** Staging news events, falsifying quotes, or publishing unverified rumors is strictly prohibited. Personnel **MUST NOT** fabricate news material under penalty of immediate termination.
3. **Separation of News and Opinion:** Standard news reporting **MUST** remain strictly objective and free from personal editorial commentary. Analytical perspectives **MAY** only be aired in designated, clearly labeled opinion or editorial programs.

2.2 Minimize Harm

1. **Compassion in Tragedy:** Personnel **SHOULD** treat accident victims, grieving families, and individuals affected by violent crimes with dignity, empathy, and professional respect.
2. **Protection of Vulnerable Identities:** Personnel **MUST NOT** publish the names, unblurred faces, or identifying characteristics of minors or victims of sexual offenses.
3. **Public Interest Balance:** Legal access to an event does not automatically make its broadcast ethical. Staff **MUST** exercise editorial discretion before airing excessively graphic imagery or depictions of fatal trauma.

2.3 Act Independently

1. **Conflict of Interest:** Journalists **MUST NOT** cover stories involving their personal business ventures, immediate family, or private organizations in which they hold a direct financial or operational stake.
2. **Prohibition of Extralegal & Unverified Private Intelligence:** Personnel **MUST NOT** utilize clandestine hearsay, unverified private disclosures, or intelligence obtained through personal, non-journalistic external affiliations for LSNN reporting purposes. All reporting material **MUST** be acquired strictly through verified whistleblowers, public records, accredited press briefings, or documented on-scene reporting. Sourcing news through illegitimate or fabricated personal channels constitutes gross journalistic fraud and operational perjury.
3. **Mandatory Disclosure of Interests:**
 - a. Reporters **MUST** disclose to their editor/producer if they have any personal, familial, commercial, or organizational relationship with a source or story subject.
 - b. The editor **MUST** determine whether the reporter may continue covering the story or must be substituted by neutral personnel.
4. **Refusal of Gratuities:** Personnel **MUST** decline all gifts, cash bribes, VIP favors, or special access intended to influence news angle or suppress investigation.
5. **Separation of Editorial and Commercial Content:** Personnel **MUST NOT** disguise paid commercial advertisements as genuine investigative journalism. All paid promotional materials **MUST** be explicitly labeled as "*Sponsored Content*" or "*Advertorial*".

2.4 Be Accountable and Transparent

1. **Prompt Corrections:** If erroneous data or incorrect statements are aired or published, editorial staff **MUST** promptly issue a public retraction and formal correction.
2. **Retraction Procedure:**
 - a. The decision to retract a published story **MUST** be made by a minimum of a Producer (*Content Lead*) or above through the Editorial Decision Chain (see Chapter IV §4.4).

- b. Retracted stories **MUST** be clearly labeled "[RETRACTED]" in the original headline, accompanied by a brief explanation of the reason for retraction.
- c. All retractions and their error chronology **MUST** be recorded in the internal editorial archive (*Retraction Log*).

3. **Public Correction Format:** When an error is identified but the story does not warrant full retraction, editorial staff **MUST** publish a correction following this standard format:

- a. Correction headline: "[CORRECTION] – [Original Story Title]".
- b. The correction body **MUST** state: which part was erroneous, the correct information, and the verification source for the correct data.
- c. Corrections **MUST** be published within a maximum of **6 hours** after the error is identified.

4. **Internal Accountability:**

- a. The **reporter** who authored the erroneous story is responsible for preparing the correction draft.
- b. The **editor/producer** who approved the original publication shares responsibility for the editorial verification failure.
- c. Repeated errors by the same personnel **SHALL** be evaluated through the Progressive Disciplinary System (Chapter IX §9.2).

5. **Open Editorial Process:** Editorial desks **SHOULD** welcome constructive inquiries from the public regarding network reporting methods and journalistic integrity.



Chapter III.
Corporate Governance
& Organizational Structure

3.1 Chain of Command Flowchart

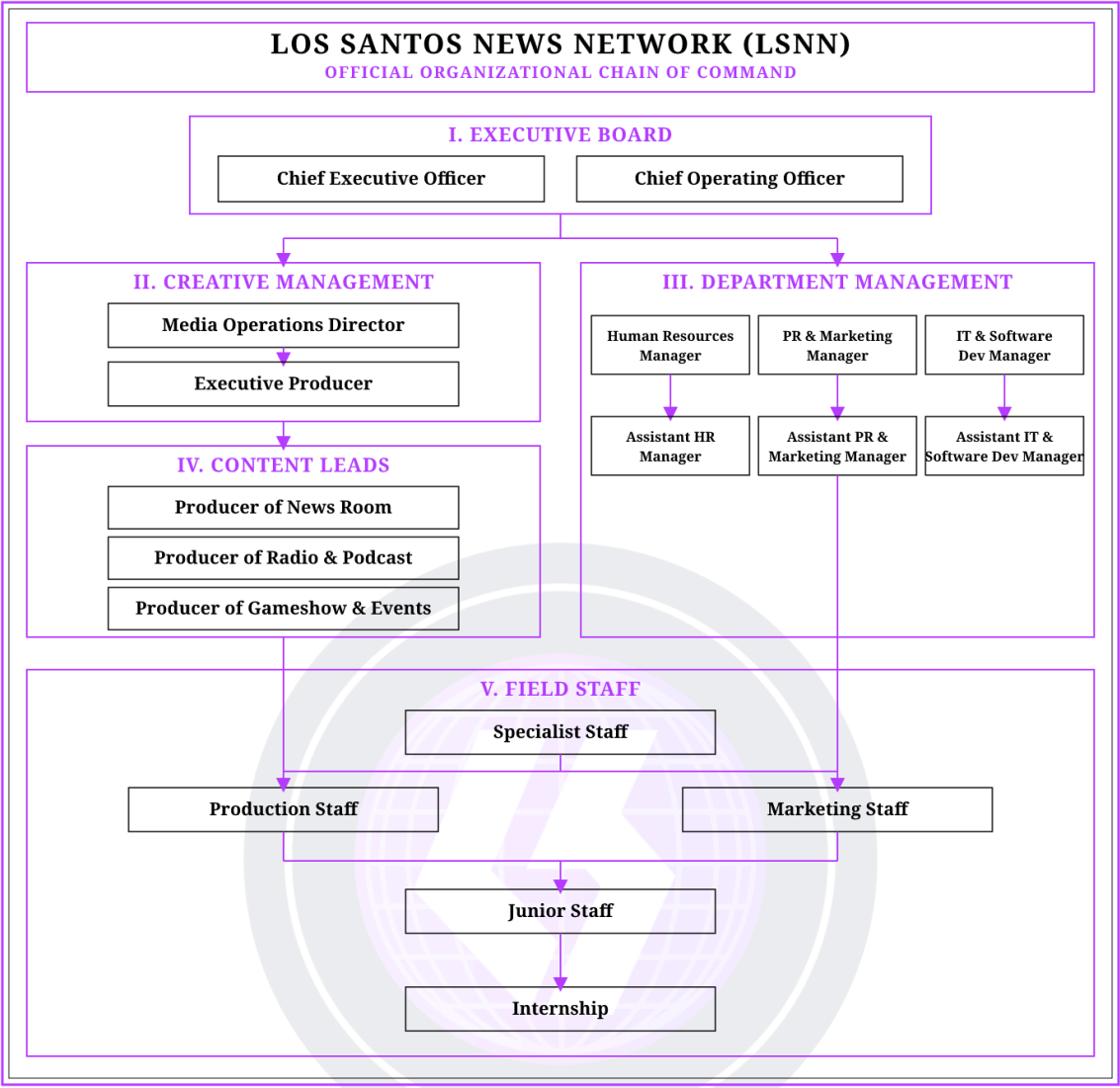


Figure: LSNN Official Organizational Chain of Command

3.2 Corporate Divisions & Official Positions

Corporate Division	Official Job Title	Primary Operational Scope
I. Executive Board	Chief Executive Officer (CEO)	Supreme executive leader, strategic policy maker, institutional license holder, and public network representative.
	Chief Operating Officer (COO)	Daily operations director, inter-departmental overseer, and acting executive during CEO absence.
II. Creative Management	Media Operations Director (MOD)	Broadcast quality assurance, fleet and studio readiness, and technical workflow controller.
	Executive Producer (EP)	Editor-in-Chief of daily news, broadcast schedule curator, and producer task supervisor.
III. Department Management	HR Manager	Staff recruitment, personnel records (<i>HR Records</i>), duty tracking, and workplace conduct enforcement.
	Public Relations & Marketing Manager	Commercial ad contracts, municipal billboard leasing, corporate sponsorships, and municipal relations.
	IT & Software Development Manager	Transmission network maintenance, internal editorial portal, stage multimedia consoles, and digital interactive systems.
	Assistant Managers	Administrative and field support to department managers within their designated branches.
	Producer of News Room	Journalism desk coordinator, daily field beats, breaking news verifier, and investigative editor.
IV. Content Leads	Producer of Radio & Podcast	Radio broadcast schedules, talkshow lineups, podcast releases, and on-air host rotation.
	Producer of Gameshow & Events	Stage entertainment director, public auctions, interactive contests, and live event logistics.
	Specialist Staff	Senior experienced personnel (Lead Investigative Reporter, Senior RJ, Head Graphic Designer).
V. Field & Operational Staff	Production Staff	Field technical crew (Camera Operators, Audio Engineers, Video Editors, Broadcast Techs).
	Marketing Staff	Client service staff handling walk-in commercial ad bookings and billboard campaigns.
	Junior Staff	Accredited regular field journalists and camera operators who have completed probation.

Corporate Division	Official Job Title	Primary Operational Scope
	Internship	Entry-level trainees undergoing foundational training while shadowing senior journalists.

3.3 Key Performance Indicators (KPI) & Career Advancement

Advancement through the organizational hierarchy is assessed objectively based on four metrics:

- 1. **Field Productivity:** Frequency and consistency of published articles, live on-air broadcasting hours, and advertising account acquisition.
 - 2. **Journalistic Craft:** Mastery of the inverted pyramid structure, grammatical precision, fact-checking accuracy, and clean camera composition.
 - 3. **Discipline & Duty Hours:** Fulfillment of weekly duty quotas, care of network vehicles, and adherence to radio protocol.
 - 4. **Teamwork & Initiative:** Effective coordination during high-pressure breaking news events and live stage productions.
- Note: Lateral entry into specialized operational positions may be granted to candidates possessing verified professional portfolios.*



Chapter IV.
The Newsroom
& The Craft of Journalism

4.1 The Inverted Pyramid Writing Structure

Every published news report and broadcast script **MUST** follow the inverted pyramid model, placing the most critical facts at the beginning:

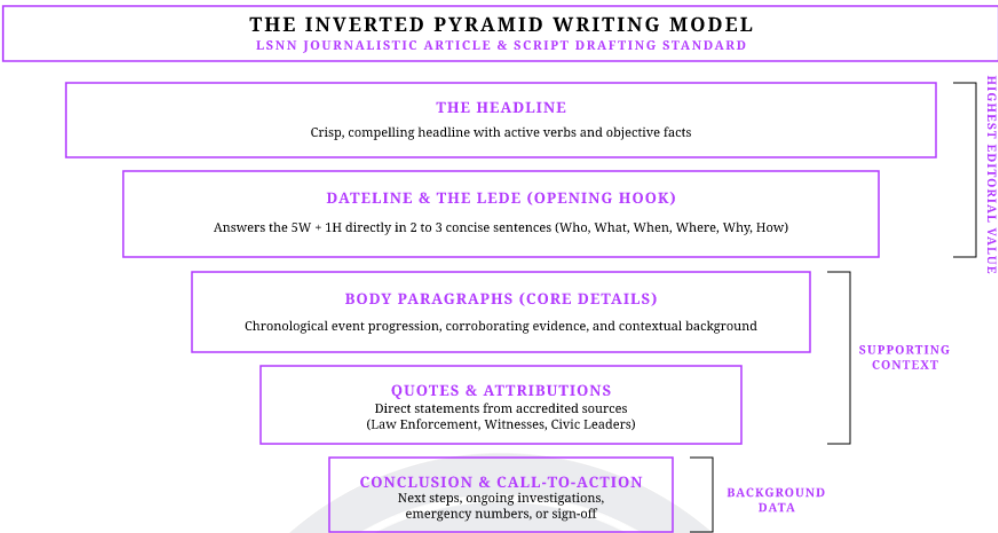


Figure: The Inverted Pyramid Writing Model

Drafting Standards:

- 1. **Headline:** Writers **MUST** use active verbs and concise phrasing. Clickbait headlines that mislead readers **MUST NOT** be published.
- 2. **Dateline:** Standard dateline format **MUST** strictly adhere to: **LOS SANTOS, SA - [Date]**.
- 3. **The Lede:** The opening paragraph **MUST** establish the core incident (Who, What, Where, When, Why) immediately without filler prose.
- 4. **Quotes:** Spoken statements **MUST** be placed in quotation marks with clear, verifiable attribution, for example: *"The perimeter is fully secured and there is no active threat to the neighborhood," stated an LSPD Field Supervisor.*

4.2 Sourcing Tiers

Reporters **MUST** establish clear ground rules with interviewees prior to recording statements:

- 1. **On the Record:** The informant's full name, title, and statements **MAY** be directly quoted and published. This is the baseline standard for LSNN reporting.
- 2. **On Background:** Information and statements **MAY** be published, but the source's name **MUST** remain withheld and replaced by a generic professional title, such as *"a senior detective within the Los Santos Police Department"*.
- 3. **Off the Record:** Information **MUST NOT** be published, broadcast, or quoted in any manner. It serves exclusively as confidential investigatory background to corroborate facts or locate secondary sources willing to speak on the record.

4.3 Operational Field Photography Guidelines

Photo documentation serves as empirical evidence of field occurrences. All staff **MUST** comply with professional visual standards:

- 1. **Composition & Perspective:**
 - a. Photographers **SHOULD** employ the Rule of Thirds. The primary focal subject (emergency vehicles, incident scene, official spokesperson) **MUST** be clearly framed.

b. Field camera operators **MUST** utilize natural human perspective and realistic field of view (FOV).

2. Lighting & Clarity:

a. Crews **SHOULD NOT** submit pitch-black or underexposed imagery. Photographers **SHOULD** utilize auxiliary vehicle headlights, ambient street lamps, or portable studio lighting to illuminate nighttime scenes.

b. Camera operators **MUST** ensure sharp optical lens focus on the central subject matter.

3. Optical Sensor Integrity & Anti-Manipulation Standard:

a. All press photography **MUST** represent authentic, unaltered optical captures obtained directly through professional camera equipment.

b. Published images **MUST NOT** feature synthetic graphic overlays, artificial focal reticles, embedded data stamps, or non-diegetic visual distortions.

c. The Photo Desk **SHALL** immediately reject any submission that fails optical authenticity standards. Rejected submissions **SHALL NOT** qualify for editorial compensation or publication credit.

4.4 Editorial Decision Chain

To prevent internal conflicts and ensure publication accountability, LSNN implements a clear editorial decision hierarchy:

1. Publication Approval Hierarchy:

a. **Routine News** (daily coverage, general events): The on-duty editor or assigned Producer holds authority to approve or revise manuscripts prior to publication.

b. **Sensitive Stories** (directly involving LSPD/LSSD, major factions, or widespread community impact): **MUST** be escalated to the *Executive Producer* or *Media Operations Director* for review prior to publication.

c. **High-Impact Stories** (potentially causing widespread crisis, containing serious allegations against public institutions, or carrying major legal liability): **MUST** receive final approval from the *Chief Executive Officer*.

2. Definition of Sensitive Stories: A story is classified as sensitive when it meets one or more of the following criteria:

a. Names or concerns the official operations of government agencies (LSPD, LSSD, LSFD, City Hall).

b. Contains allegations of legal violations, ethical breaches, or suspected corruption against individuals or corporations.

c. Has the potential to generate widespread community reaction or inter-faction conflict.

3. Kill Story Policy:

a. The decision to hold or kill a story **MAY ONLY** be made by an authorized Producer or senior management.

b. Every held or killed story **MUST** have its reasoning documented in the internal editorial archive, including who made the decision and on what grounds.

4. Assignment Claim Protocol:

a. Story assignments follow the "*first come, first served*" principle — the personnel who first acknowledges and logs the incoming dispatch report, or announces via corporate radio that they are *en route* to the location, holds lead coverage rights.

b. Other personnel arriving on scene **SHOULD** coordinate to assume supporting roles (camera operator, interview assistant) rather than contesting the lead assignment.

c. Assignment disputes are resolved by the on-duty editor based on capability and urgency assessment.

Chapter V.
Emergency Scene Protocols
& Law Enforcement
Relations

5.1 Working with Law Enforcement & Emergency Services

Police agencies (LSPD, LSSD) and emergency services (LSFD) are our field partners:

- 1. Command Coordination:** Information inquiries on-scene **MUST** be directed to the designated Public Information Officer (PIO) or Incident Commander.
- 2. Non-Interference with Tactical Operations:** Personnel **MUST NOT** debate or interfere with tactical instructions given by emergency personnel in an active hazard zone. Disagreements **SHOULD** be handled through the station Liaison Desk.

5.2 Crime Scene Cordons & Media Staging

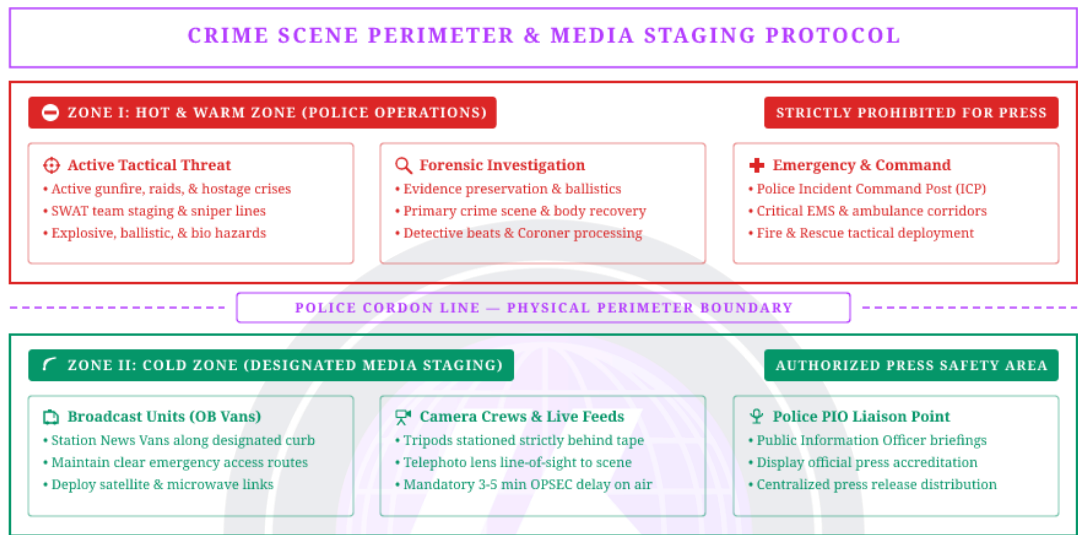


Figure: Crime Scene Perimeter & Media Staging Protocol

- 1. Police Tape Perimeter:** Reporters **MUST NOT** cross, duck under, or tamper with police cordons without explicit authorization from the Incident Commander.
- 2. Media Staging:** Field crews **MUST** station the News Van and production assets within the agreed media staging area to prevent obstructing emergency vehicle access routes.

5.3 Active Shooters, Tactical Raids & Hostage Crises (OPSEC)

When covering ongoing high-risk tactical engagements:

- 1. Broadcast Delay (Operational Security / OPSEC):**
 - a. To protect officer and hostage safety, personnel **MUST NOT** broadcast live feeds displaying tactical team staging positions, tactical marksman locations, or active breach routes in real time.
 - b. Outside broadcast units **MUST** impose a mandatory 3 to 5 minute delay on live transmissions, or withhold tactical footage until the Incident Commander confirms the operation is completed.
- 2. No Contact with Hostage Takers:** Reporters **MUST NOT** contact or attempt to interview captors during active negotiations, as unauthorized interference directly endangers human life.

5.4 Life Safety First Protocol

The bedrock safety principle of LSNN: "No story is worth a journalist's life."

- 1. Compliance Under Duress:**
 - a. Personnel **MUST** remain calm, follow physical directives, and avoid sudden provocative movements.

- b. Personnel **MUST** surrender cameras, press credentials, and vehicle keys without hesitation if demanded under threat of violence. Equipment can be replaced; human lives cannot.
- 2. **Prohibition of Clandestine Transmissions:** Personnel **MUST NOT** attempt covert broadcasts or clandestine radio transmissions while under direct custody of hostile elements.

5.5 Advanced Law Enforcement Relations Protocols

In addition to standard procedures in §5.1–5.4, LSNN establishes protocols for advanced scenarios involving potential conflicts with law enforcement:

1. Requests to Remove Published Stories by LSPD/LSSD:

- a. When law enforcement requests LSNN to remove or retract a published story, field personnel **MUST NOT** make the decision independently.
- b. Such requests **MUST** be escalated through the *Editorial Decision Chain* (see Chapter IV §4.4): Editor → *Managing Editor* → CEO.
- c. LSNN reserves the right to refuse removal requests when the story has met two-source verification standards and does not violate applicable legal provisions.
- d. If LSNN decides to refuse, the refusal **MUST** be communicated professionally and documented through the *Liaison Desk*.

2. Seizure of Journalist Cameras or Recordings:

- a. When authorities seize recording equipment or journalistic materials, personnel **MUST** lodge a polite, professional objection citing protection rights under the *San Andreas Shield Law* (see Chapter I §1.3).
- b. Personnel **MUST** record the identity of the seizing officer (name, rank, unit) and report the incident to the CEO for formal legal counsel and institutional recourse.
- c. Personnel **MUST NOT** physically resist seizure; dispute resolution is pursued through legal and inter-agency diplomatic channels.

3. Erroneous Official Information from PIO/Spokesperson:

- a. LSNN remains bound by the *Two-Source Rule* (Chapter II §2.1.1); PIO information **MUST NOT** serve as the sole basis for publication.
- b. When a story sourced from official PIO statements proves erroneous, LSNN **MUST** issue a correction with the clause: *"Initial information was sourced from official law enforcement statements that were subsequently corrected by authorities."*
- c. Such corrections **MUST NOT** serve as grounds for disciplinary action against the reporter, provided the reporter followed applicable verification procedures.

4. Recordings of Suspected Excessive Force (Police Brutality):

- a. When personnel record or witness suspected excessive force by officers, the footage **MUST** be secured and reported directly to the *Managing Editor* or CEO.
- b. The decision to publish such footage **MAY ONLY** be made by the CEO after careful consideration of civic public impact and legal escalation risks.
- c. Personnel **MUST NOT** distribute sensitive footage through personal channels or media outside LSNN's control.

5. Coverage Restriction Orders (Gag Orders) from Law Enforcement:

- a. When authorities issue a coverage restriction order, field personnel **MUST** temporarily comply and immediately report it to the CEO.
- b. The CEO together with the *Editorial Board* **SHALL** evaluate the legitimacy of the order and determine LSNN's official stance: comply, negotiate restrictions, or refuse with press law justification.

Chapter VI.
**Broadcasting Standards,
Frequency Transmission
& Production Governance**

6.1 On-Air Voice, Decorum & Tone Guidelines

1. **Clarity & Articulation:** On-air broadcasters **MUST** maintain professional, measured, and authoritative speech during all transmissions.
2. **Zero Profanity Policy:** Swearing, offensive slurs, sexual remarks, or hate speech over public broadcast waves **SHALL** result in immediate on-air suspension and formal disciplinary review.
3. **Composure Under Crisis:** Presenters **MUST** maintain a calm vocal delivery during disaster reporting to prevent civil panic.

6.2 Technical Field Broadcasting & Over-the-Air Transmission Standards

All broadcast crews **MUST** comply with operational transmitter standards and audio-visual transmission procedures:

1. **Field Broadcast Frequency Perimeter Management:**
 - a. Mobile Outside Broadcast units (OB Trucks) and portable transmitters **MUST** calibrate their transmission radius to match the designated broadcast zone.
 - b. Restricting transmitter radius ensures pristine vocal modulation for hosts, prevents transmission bleed into emergency channels, and avoids stray signal interference from outside the event venue.
2. **Audio Routing & Guest Channel Management (Master Control Room Link):**
 - a. Opening a live on-air feed to the public network **REQUIRES** real-time coordination with Master Control Room (MCR) engineers at headquarters.
 - b. Patching remote interviewees or field guests into the broadcast console **MUST** undergo prior audio line testing (patch test) to ensure balanced volume levels across all microphones.
 - c. Concluding news broadcasts **MUST** be executed with synchronized sign-off cues to prevent dead air across public frequencies.
3. **Emergency Dispatch Protocol & Switchboard Operations:**
 - a. Switchboard intake staff **MUST** log, classify, and verify incoming citizen emergency reports and eyewitness phone tips.
 - b. Duty dispatchers **MUST** classify incident priority, route the nearest mobile news beat unit to the scene coordinates, and track reporting progress until the story concludes.
4. **Municipal Navigation Network Integration & Public Waypoint Signals:**
 - a. Broadcasting location signals for open stage events **MUST** synchronize with municipal digital mapping networks so citizens can locate official venue sites.
 - b. Public navigation event signals **MUST** be deactivated immediately following event conclusion to maintain orderly civic information systems.
5. **Stage Multimedia Systems & Central Screen Console Management:**
 - a. Operation of stage multimedia video screens **MUST** be directed by dedicated broadcast technicians to display contest graphics, auction listings, or presentation visuals.
 - b. Technical operators **MUST** ensure real-time synchronization between the host's spoken cues and on-screen graphical transitions.

6.3 Pre-Production Governance: Editorial Program Clearance

Special program segments, talkshows, podcasts, and major stage events **MUST** complete editorial clearance at least **12 hours prior to air time**:

1. **Executive Rundown Dossier:** Outlines the core theme, civic value, target audience, and step-by-step segment flow from introduction to main dialogue and closing.
2. **Guest & Interview Dossier:** Profiles confirmed interviewees, establishes their subject matter relevance, and provides a structured draft of objective questions.

3. **Technical & Logistics Rider:** Designates assigned vehicle assets (News Van, OB Truck, or News Chopper), crew roster (camera operators, audio engineers), and special studio staging requirements.
4. **Fiscal & Prize Budget Plan:** Itemizes projected operational logistics costs or confirms authorized cash prize pools for public stage contests.
5. **Editorial Clearance Approval:** No live broadcast **MAY** proceed without formal authorization (Approved status) from the designated Producer or Executive Producer.

6.4 Post-Production Governance: Broadcast Audit & Financial Reconciliation

Within **24 hours following broadcast conclusion**, the production crew **MUST** file a comprehensive post-broadcast audit in the official Production Ledger:

1. **Broadcast Performance Log:** Documents actual on-air duration, estimated audience reach, public interaction, and a factual summary of information delivered.
2. **Technical Incident Log:** Records frequency challenges, on-scene emergency service coordination, and crew performance evaluations for future productions.
3. **Financial Claim Reconciliation:**
 - a. **Reimbursement:** Reconciles legitimate out-of-pocket operating expenses incurred by the crew in the field (stage props, venue booking fees, technical logistics).
 - b. **Performance Bonus:** Production incentive disbursement for on-air talent and technical crew deployed in the field.
 - c. **Prize Payout:** Disbursement authorization for cash prizes awarded to verified contest or public auction winners.
4. **Certified Banking Proof Requirement:** Every financial claim **MUST** be accompanied by an authenticated bank transfer receipt or official statement slip. Unsubstantiated claims **SHALL NOT** be processed by the Corporate Treasury.

Chapter VII.
Commercial Services,
Advertising
& Compensation Scheme

7.1 Permitted Commercial Advertisements

LSNN broadcasts promotional campaigns for licensed businesses and civic organizations:

1. **Eligible Categories:** Licensed commercial businesses (garages, dining establishments, nightlife, retail stores), corporate job recruitments, verified real estate and vehicular sales, public community events, and government service announcements.
2. **Transmission Formats:** Automated commercial campaigns through scheduled wire broadcasts (Scheduled Wire Commercials) and digital public display networks (Municipal Digital Billboard Network).

7.2 Prohibited / Blacklisted Advertisements

LSNN enforces an absolute institutional ban on advertising content that promotes:

1. Unlicensed firearms, illegal ammunition, explosives, or untraceable weaponry.
2. Narcotics, controlled substances, or illegal narcotics trafficking.
3. Prostitution, human trafficking, or sexually explicit services.
4. Harassment, political slander, personal vendettas, civil hostility, or defamatory smear campaigns.

Personnel who approve or transmit blacklisted advertisements **SHALL** face immediate dishonorable discharge.

7.3 Sales Commission & Treasury Remittance

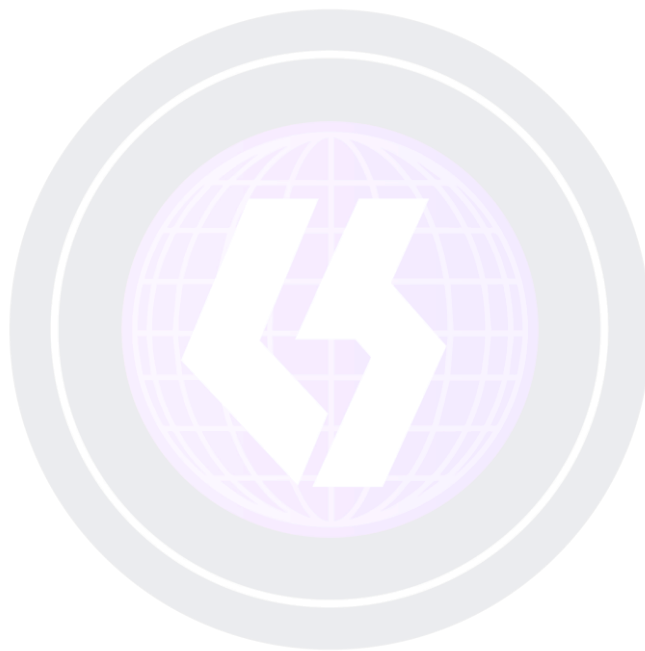
1. **Sales Commission Entitlement:** Personnel who secure verified commercial advertising contracts or billboard leases **SHALL** be entitled to a sales commission of **25%** of the gross client fee (subject to the Official Commercial Rate Card).
2. **Transaction Validation:** Every commission claim **MUST** be validated by at least one person who is **NOT** the salesperson themselves (supervisor, editor, or on-duty manager). Transactions without independent validation **SHALL NOT** be processed.
3. **Faction Vault Deposit Mandate:** All client fees **MUST** be deposited directly (*cash*) into the **LSNN Faction Vault (Faction Bank)**. Personnel **MUST NOT** deduct commission cuts prior to validated deposit.
4. **Broadcast Payment Scheme:**
 - a. **Host (Anchor/Presenter):** Primary recipient of live broadcast performance incentives.
 - b. **Supporting Crew** (camera operators, field reporters, technicians): Entitled to operational crew allowance when actively participating in broadcasts.
 - c. **Interns (Internship):** Entitled to a small operational stipend when assigned as broadcast support crew.
5. **Reimbursement Standards:**
 - a. Every reimbursement claim **MUST** reference the standard rate table established by the *Corporate Treasury*.
 - b. All claims **MUST** be accompanied by authentic, unmanipulated corporate banking transaction slips, wire receipts, or certified account statements.
 - c. A weekly maximum claim cap per personnel is imposed based on corporate title and operational necessity.
6. **Financial Transparency:** All incoming and outgoing transactions **MUST** be logged in the official Corporate Treasury Ledger and are subject to audit by Department Management or the Executive Board at any time.

7.4 Multi-Tier Payroll Scheme

Employee compensation is calculated transparently through a four-part structure:

1. **Weekly Base Salary:** Fixed weekly stipend based on appointed corporate title, provided the employee satisfies activity-based duty quotas.
2. **Pay-per-Article:** Monetary bonus awarded for each approved investigative report or written article published.
3. **Broadcast Performance Bonus:** Production incentive awarded to hosts (anchors) conducting live on-air broadcasting, plus operational crew allowance for supporting staff.
4. **Sales Commission:** 25% revenue share derived from validated commercial advertisement sales and billboard leases.

All disbursements **SHALL** be issued weekly upon formal audit and authorization by the Executive Board.



Chapter VIII.
Fleet Logistics, Attire
& Workplace Conduct

8.1 Fleet Vehicle Management

Network vehicles represent our corporate image across San Andreas:

- **News Van:** Primary transport for daily news beats and camera equipment.
- **Outside Broadcast (OB) Truck:** Heavy mobile studio for live events, stage shows, and major remote broadcasts.
- **News Chopper:** Aviation asset dedicated to highway traffic reports, emergency scenes, and search operations.

Fleet Guidelines:

1. Fleet vehicles **MAY ONLY** be operated by accredited personnel in official uniform during active duty hours.
2. Personnel **MUST NOT** utilize company vehicles for personal errands, unauthorized street racing, or unlawful activities; violations **SHALL** result in immediate dishonorable discharge.
3. Drivers **MUST** comply with municipal traffic safety regulations and exercise due operational caution.
4. Upon concluding duty assignments, vehicles **MUST** be returned to the corporate garage clean, parked in designated bays, and refueled.

8.2 Dress Codes & Press Pass Display

Category	Uniform & Attire Standards
1. Office Formal (Administrative & Civic Meetings)	Clean button-up shirt, suit/blazer, tailored trousers, and dress shoes. Worn in office quarters, executive meetings, and formal interviews with government leaders.
2. On-Air Attire (Studio & Stage)	Professional, stylish, and camera-ready studio clothing suitable for television broadcast or live event hosting.
3. Field Operations (Field Beats & Emergency Scenes)	Durable field clothing, tactical/cargo pants, work boots, and the Official Press Vest bearing the LSNN logo with the employee Press Pass visibly displayed.

1. **Mandatory Display:** The official Press Pass **MUST** remain visibly displayed during all field reporting assignments.
2. **Transfer Prohibition:** Personnel **MUST NOT** loan, sell, duplicate, or transfer press credentials to unauthorized individuals under penalty of immediate termination.

8.3 Corporate Radio Etiquette

1. **Channel Reservation:** Corporate radio frequencies **MUST** be reserved strictly for assignment dispatch, vehicular coordination, and operational updates.
2. **Professional Transmission:** Transmissions **MUST** remain brief, objective, and professional. Personnel **MUST NOT** broadcast casual chatter, unauthorized audio, or personal disputes over corporate frequencies.

8.4 Activity-Based Duty Quotas & Leave of Absence (LOA)

1. **Contribution-Based Activity Quotas:** Rather than relying solely on logged duty hours, LSNN evaluates personnel activity through measurable contributions:

Corporate Tier	Minimum Weekly Expectation
Junior Tier (Internship & Junior Staff)	1 event/coverage attendance OR 1 ride-along with senior staff
Operational Tier (Production, Marketing & Specialist Staff)	2 contributions (coverage/article/ad sold/broadcast participation)
Management Tier (Content Leads & Department Managers)	2 contributions + 1 mentoring/editorial review session
Executive Tier (Creative Management & Executive Board)	1 contribution + oversight duties fulfillment

2. Leave of Absence (LOA) Procedure:

a. Personnel requiring planned absences **MUST** submit an official Leave of Absence petition to the HR Department prior to departure.

b. Duration Guidelines:

Absence Duration	Requirement
1–3 days	No penalty; verbal notification via corporate dispatch radio or written memo to HR is sufficient
4–7 days	MUST formally notify HR Manager before leave begins
8–14 days	MUST obtain written CEO approval; operational duties temporarily reassigned
Over 14 days	Employment status review by the Executive Board

3. **Abandonment Sanctions:** Unexcused absences exceeding 7 consecutive calendar days **SHALL** trigger immediate employment review and potential termination.

Chapter IX.
**Disciplinary Enforcement
& Ratification**

9.1 Major Misconduct Classifications

The following violations **SHALL** warrant immediate Dishonorable Discharge:

- 1. **Financial Embezzlement:** Stealing advertising fees, unapproved treasury deductions, or accepting bribes to manipulate news coverage.
- 2. **Abuse of Press Credentials:** Operating press vehicles or displaying press badges during criminal operations, or aiding fleeing fugitives.
- 3. **Severe Ethical Violations:** Deliberate fabrication of news reports, releasing unredacted identities of protected victims without authorization, or leaking proprietary network files.

9.2 Progressive Disciplinary System

Disciplinary Level	Scope & Sanction Parameters
Level 1: First Written Warning	Formal counseling and official reprimand logged in HR records for first-time or minor operational infractions. 14-day observation period.
Level 2: Final Written Notice & Operational Suspension	Severe administrative reprimand. Temporary suspension from live broadcasts, freeze on promotion eligibility, and revocation of advertising commission privileges during a 30-day penalty period.
Level 3: Executive Sanction & Termination	Administrative demotion to a preceding operational position, extended disciplinary suspension, or Dishonorable Discharge upon Corporate Directorate review.

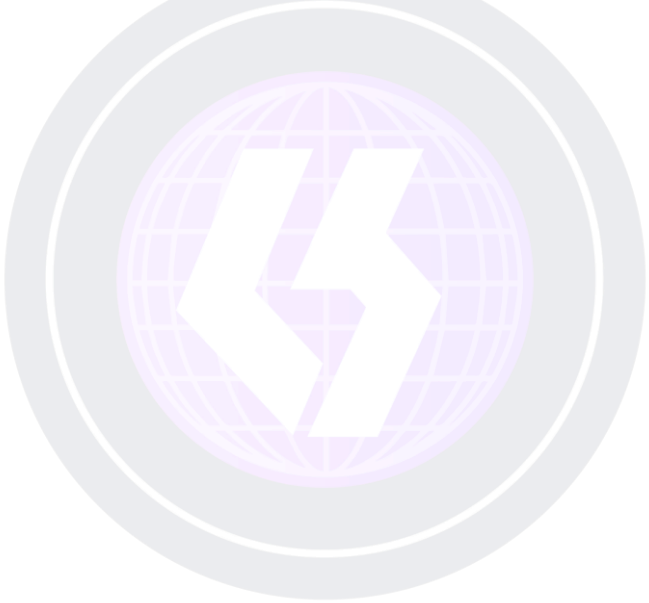
9.3 Corporate Blacklist Sanctions

- 1. Employees separated through Dishonorable Discharge for gross misconduct **MAY** be placed on the *Corporate Blacklist* upon Executive Board ratification, permanently disqualifying them from re-employment across all divisions of the Los Santos News Network.

9.4 Corporate Board Ratification Sheet

CORPORATE BOARD RATIFICATION SHEET LOS SANTOS NEWS NETWORK CORPORATE BOARD	
Promulgated At	: Los Santos News Network Headquarters
Document Classification	: Master Field & Operational Policy Directive
Operational Scope	: Legally Binding Upon All Corporate Personnel
<i>Representing the Corporate Directorate:</i>	
Ratified By, Chief Executive Officer (.....) Los Santos News Network	Approved By, Chief Operating Officer (.....) Los Santos News Network
	Attested By, Media Operations Director (.....) Los Santos News Network

Figure: Corporate Board Ratification Sheet



9.5 Employee Integrity & Commitment Pledge

EMPLOYEE INTEGRITY & COMMITMENT PLEDGE LOS SANTOS NEWS NETWORK • OFFICIAL COMPLIANCE & ETHICS DECLARATION	
EMPLOYEE OFFICIAL CREDENTIALS: Full Employee Name : Official Press Pass ID : Initial Appointed Position : Assigned Department :	
HEREBY DECLARE AND SOLEMNLY PLEDGE THAT: 1. Handbook Policy Compliance: I have thoroughly read, understood, and solemnly pledge to adhere to all policies set forth in the LSNN Field & Operational Employee Handbook without exception. 2. Journalistic Integrity & Anti-Bribery (SPJ Benchmark): I shall uphold the SPJ Code of Ethics, prioritize factual truth in reporting, and reject all compromises, bribes, or private interests that damage press integrity and institutional credibility. 3. Data Confidentiality & Corporate Asset Stewardship: I shall preserve the confidentiality of internal network records and whistleblowers, responsibly maintain facilities and fleet units entrusted to my care, and conduct myself professionally before the public and authorities. 4. Disciplinary System & Corporate Blacklist Sanctions: I acknowledge the disciplinary system in force (Progressive Sanctions), and accept that any severe violation may result in immediate Dishonorable Discharge and placement on the permanent Corporate Blacklist.	
<i>Executed and signed in Los Santos, State of San Andreas, on this date:</i>	
Employee Declaration, Undersigned Pledger (.....) Signature & Full Legal Name	Attested & Verified By, Human Resources Department (HR) (.....) HR Manager / Department Management

Figure: Employee Integrity & Commitment Pledge

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